2.11 Excessive Fluid Volume*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My legs are swollen." **Objective** • Pitting edema +3 in both legs • Gained 2 kg in 2 days • Intake exceeds output	**ACTUAL** Excessive fluid volume related to compromised regulatory mechanisms as evidenced by edema, weight gain and positive fluid balance.	• Edema decreasing and weight approaching baseline within 3 days.	• Weigh daily: same time, same scale. • Keep a strict intake and output record. • Restrict fluid and sodium as prescribed. • Give diuretics as ordered and follow serum potassium. • Elevate the swollen limbs.	• Outcome reached as edema and weight fall.
Subjective • "I get short of breath when lying flat." **Objective** • Crackles at the bases • SpO_2 91% • RR 26/min	**ACTUAL** Impaired gas exchange related to pulmonary congestion as evidenced by crackles, dyspnea and low SpO_2.	• SpO_2 94% or above within 12 hours.	• Sit him upright or semi-Fowler. • Give oxygen as prescribed. • Auscultate the chest every 4 hours. • Check arterial blood gases as ordered.	• Considered met at SpO_2 95% with less breathlessness.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Generalized edema • Reduced mobility	**RISK** Risk for impaired skin integrity as evidenced by risk factors: edema and immobility.	• Skin over edematous areas stays intact throughout the admission.	• Inspect swollen areas and bony prominences every shift. • Reposition two-hourly and raise swollen limbs. • Keep tight clothing, tape and restraints off edematous skin. • Keep skin clean, dry and moisturized.	• Goal reached if the skin remains intact.

*References for this care plan: [17], [33], [35], [37], [130]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.